

BASEBALL CHATTER

McGraw, Bush Inspired Cohen

By MAX GREENWALD, Star Sports Writer

Hollywood, Fla.—Who had the greatest influence on Andy Cohen shaping his career as a baseball manager?

The new pilot of the Indianapolis Indians, who officially takes the helm against Minneapolis at Indianapolis Tuesday night, instantly answered:

"John McGraw and Donie Bush."

Both, of course, are great names in the baseball world.

McGraw was the leader of the New York Giants during some of their greatest and Cohen joined that club as a youngster of 19 in 1926.

Bush has had a career stretching over almost a half century as a player, manager and front-office boss. At present, he is president of community-owned Indians Inc. Incidentally, Cohen refers to Bush as "Donie," the nickname by which he is known to all except residents of Indianapolis.

In his home town, it always has been "Owne."

"BECAUSE I was just a youngster with the Giants, McGraw made an indelible impression on my mind. I noted his disciplinary action, his handling of men and his way of playing percentage baseball," Cohen said.

"But Donie made a profound impression because I was more mature when I was with him. I was better able to digest and absorb his methods of running club."

Bush was manager at Indianapolis for seven seasons while Cohen was a second baseman. "I received my first experience as manager while with Donie," Cohen continued, explaining that Bush several times placed him in charge of the club when the pilot would not be able to be present.

"I learned manipulation of a pitching staff, from Donie," Cohen said. Andy regards Bush as without a peer in handling of the mound staff.

COHEN DECLARED that "Donie is uncanny with pitchers. He was successful in the old Minneapolis field which was a hitters' park."

"It is a matter of knowing pitchers thoroughly so that changes are not made one batter too soon or one batter too late."

Handling of pitchers is one of two prime attributes a good manager should have, Cohen believes. The other is to maintain harmony among his play-

ers so "as to try to get the best from each man. You must determine the extent of a man's ability, then get the utmost from him."

IN TRIPLICATE?—Rip Sewell, the former blooper ball thrower who lives in Plant City, Fla., was telling about being offered a scouting job by a big league team.

"They sent me a stack of blanks two feet high that I was to fill out about prospects. So I turned down the job. Filling out those reports would have taken so much of my time that I wouldn't have any left to look at players."

OVER 39—On reporting in a souped-up Cadillac to the Miami club, Satchel Paige demonstrated again he is ready to pitch baseballs and conversation with equal facility.

"How old are you going to be this year?" the ancient hurler was asked. He answered that one with a question:

"How old did you say I was last year?"

The reporter replied: "I think I quoted you as saying you were 48."

That satisfied Satch: "Why don't you use that 48 again? That sounds like a good, round figure."

HIT AND RUN—George Shuba, outfielder who has been with all the top clubs in the Brooklyn chain, says "Hoyt Wilhelm has the best knuckleball I ever saw, Ruben Gomez the best slider and Bob Friend the best curve."

Cleveland fans will have 12 chances to win autos this year. The cars will be given away on Friday nights to the patron coming closest to guessing the actual attendance of that tilt.

Ellis Kinder is five years older than Jim Derrington's father. Kinder and young Derrington are members of the White Sox pitching staff, the 17-year-old rookie receiving a five-figure four-year installment bonus.

Virgil Trucks has quit pitching to open a beer distributorship in Lakeland, Fla.

Leo Durocher will commute from Beverly Hills, Cal., for him and NBC to challenge Dizzy Dean and CBS in telecasting baseball. NBC will originate only from Washington, Pittsburgh, Milwaukee and Cubs' park.